

Courier Companies Investigation

Royal Mail

URL: <https://www.royalmail.com>

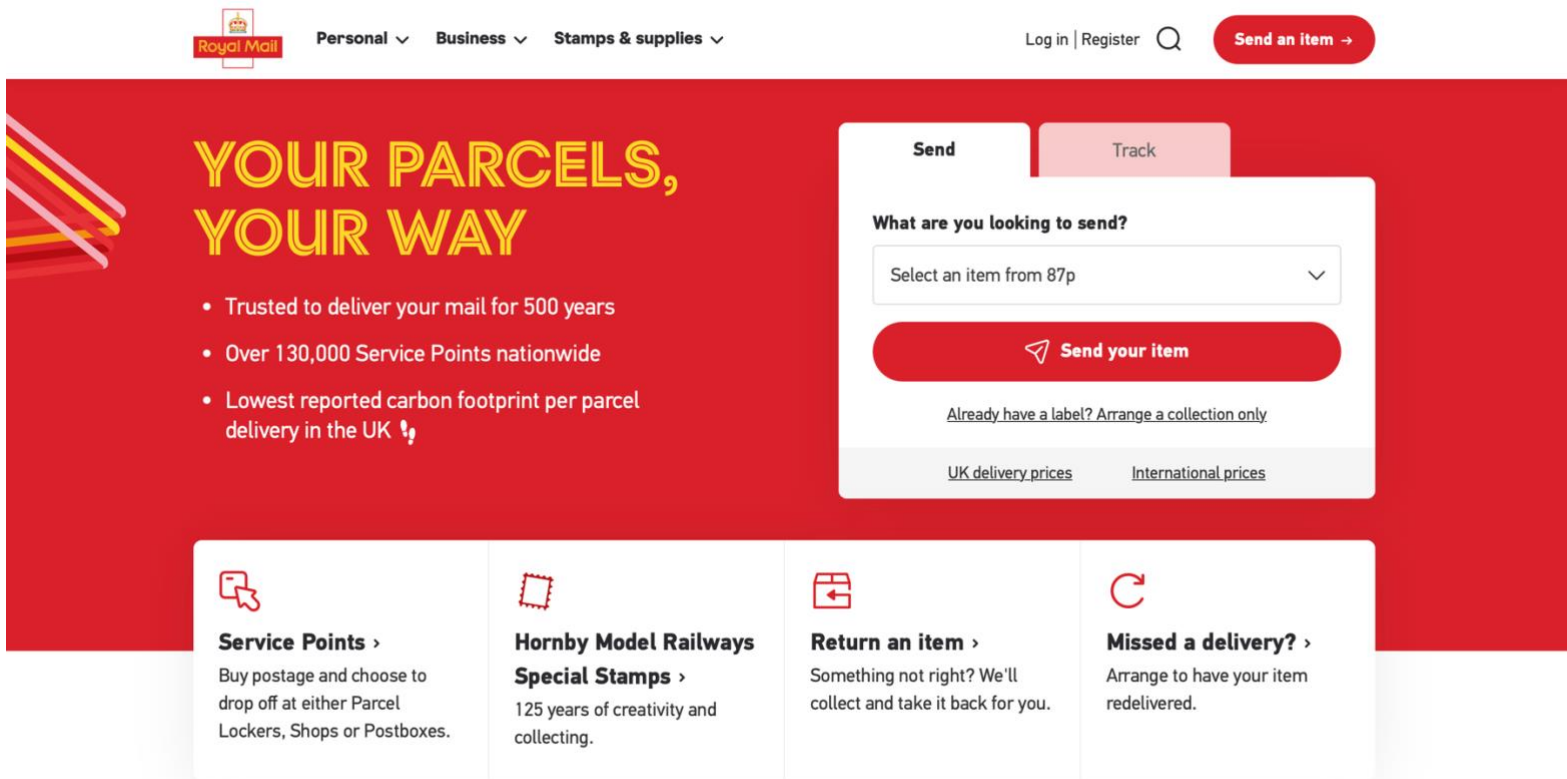


Figure 1 : Royal Mail Home Page

Royal Mail's website primarily targets individual customers, offering parcel sending and tracking as its core services. Upon arrival, users are presented with clear options for sending items or tracking existing deliveries, supported by visible pricing tiers based on parcel size and weight. Navigation is handled through a standard top menu with large dropdown sections, although the ordering process is spread across multiple pages, including destination, service selection, sender and recipient details, and payment.

Parcel tracking is available without requiring login and is accessed using a reference number. While full tracking details were not observed without completing an order, the system appears

designed to provide status updates and location history. Account registration supports both personal and business users, with optional email and SMS notifications, indicating integrated communication channels.

Figure 2 shows that the cheapest delivery options are placed within a dropdown list, making them less immediately visible. This design may influence users toward selecting higher-priced services. It also demonstrates steps of completing the order and ability to move between them.

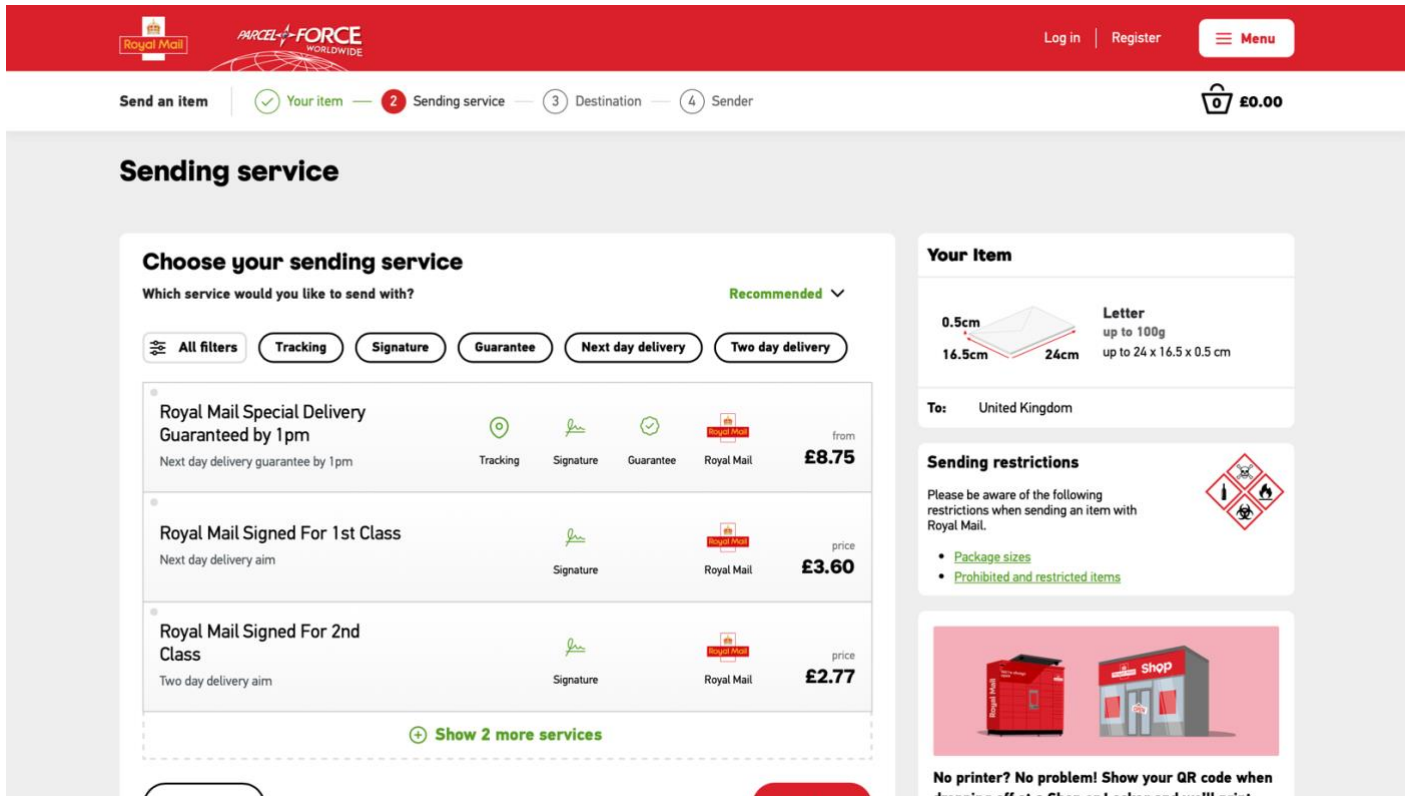


Figure 2: Sending Page

Payment is handled directly on the website using credit or debit cards, PayPal, and Apple Pay, without redirecting users to an external platform. The visual design is consistent, using a limited colour palette and clear spacing, and the site provides extensive support resources.

However, the interface contains a large amount of secondary content and promotional material, which can distract from the ordering process. The multi-page flow also makes sending parcels feel longer than necessary. Despite this, Royal Mail stands out for its professional presentation, trusted brand identity, and structured service options. Elements such as reference-based tracking, integrated payments, and clean layout principles will inform the design of my own parcel management system.

Evri

URL: <https://www.evri.com>

The screenshot shows the Evri website homepage. At the top is a dark blue navigation bar with links for 'Personal', 'Business', and 'News & Corporate' on the left, and 'Log in' and 'Sign up' on the right. Below this is a lighter blue bar with the Evri logo and the tagline 'delivery made for you'. To the right of the logo are links for 'Send', 'Track', and 'Return'. Further right are links for 'Our Services', 'ParcelShops', 'Careers', and 'Help', along with a shopping cart icon. A Trustpilot rating of 'Great' with 5,297,420 reviews is displayed. The main content area has a blue background with the headline 'A great value parcel delivery & courier service'. Below this is a white box containing the 'Send' section. It has tabs for 'Send', 'Track', and 'Return'. A green banner says 'FREE end-to-end tracking with every parcel'. The main heading is 'SEND from £2.62 (£2.18 + VAT)'. Below this is the text 'Choose a ParcelShop delivery for your cheapest way to send to the UK'. The form includes fields for 'Destination country' (set to 'United Kingdom'), 'From postcode*', 'To postcode*', and 'Weight (kg)' (set to 'Please select'). A 'Send a parcel' button is to the right. At the bottom of the form are links for 'What you can and can't send' and 'Parcel size and weight guide'. Below the form are four promotional cards: 'Global shipping' (new), 'Up to 50% savings', 'Bulk send goes global', and 'Drop off at any ParcelShop'. A wheelchair icon is in the bottom right corner.

Personal Business News & Corporate Log in | Sign up

EVRI delivery made for you Send Track Return Our Services ParcelShops Careers Help

Great 5,297,420 reviews on Trustpilot

A great value parcel delivery & courier service

Send Track Return

FREE end-to-end tracking with every parcel

SEND from £2.62 (£2.18 + VAT)

Choose a ParcelShop delivery for your cheapest way to send to the UK

Destination country From postcode* To postcode* Weight (kg)

United Kingdom Please select Send a parcel >

[What you can and can't send](#) [Parcel size and weight guide](#)

Global shipping New
Send international parcels from £6.08 - now with fewer forms & no tariff codes >

Up to 50% savings
Get exclusive discounts when you send 40+ parcels a month with Evri >

Bulk send goes global
Link your marketplaces & manage UK & international orders in one place >

Drop off at any ParcelShop
9,000+ ParcelShops to choose from across the UK >

Figure 3: EVRI Home Page

Evri's website presents a clear task-oriented layout, with prominent options for sending, tracking, and returning parcels directly on the homepage. Tracking is available without login using either a 16-digit parcel number or an 8-digit calling card number, while sending a parcel begins with a simple form requesting destination postcodes and parcel weight, with prices displayed immediately.

Figure 3 contains a Send/Track/Return section that I would be happy to incorporate in my app due to its high functionality and friendly user interface.

Navigation is straightforward, with fewer menu options than Royal Mail, which makes the interface feel less overwhelming. The parcel ordering process is largely contained within a single progressive page, where new steps appear as previous selections are completed. This

approach feels more efficient than Royal Mail’s multi-page flow. Payment is integrated directly into the website and supports card and PayPal.

However, the visual design feels less polished, with small fonts, large unused page margins, and a colour palette that reduces readability. Although email and phone number fields are presented as optional, the system does not allow users to proceed without completing them, which may confuse users. Account login is also required to finalise purchases, limiting true guest usage.

Figure 4 shows completion tracking similar to Royal Mail’s. Only after selecting the current option (e.g. “Delivery Speed”) does the next section (e.g. “Drop off or collection”) appear.

The screenshot displays the EVRI Sending Page. At the top, a blue header bar contains the text "delivery made for you". Below this is a breadcrumb trail: "Send > Delivery Options > What's in it? > Where's it going? > Your details > Payment". The main heading is "Your delivery options".

The page is divided into two main columns. The left column, titled "Delivery speed", contains two options:

- Standard** (£2.62): "Our usual great service, delivery in 2 - 4 working days. Choose from ParcelShop or Locker drop off or Courier Collection." It includes a location pin icon and text "Your nearest drop off is 0.2 miles away". A blue button with a checkmark and the text "Selected" is present.
- Next Day** (£3.20): "Delivery in 1 working day to most UK destinations. For the best chance of Next Day delivery, drop off your parcel by 12 noon." It includes an information icon and text "ParcelShop and Locker drop off only", a location pin icon and text "Your nearest drop off is 0.2 miles away", and a blue button with the text "Select".

The right column, titled "Summary", contains the following information:

- From:** YO164NQ **To:** YO149AT
- Sending restrictions:** "You can send parcels up to 120cm long and with a combined length and circumference of 245cm." A link "View parcel size limits" is provided.
- Nearest drop off location:** ONE STOP, 182-184 Quay Road, Bridlington, YO16 4JE, GB. A note states: "You can drop your parcel off at any of our ParcelShops or Lockers without changing your selection".
- Free Cover up to £20** (Free)
- Total (inc VAT)** (£2.62)

At the bottom left, a section titled "Drop off or collection" shows the "ParcelShop or Locker Drop off" option (£2.62) with the text "Delivery usually in 2 - 3 working days from drop off." A blue accessibility icon is located in the bottom right corner.

Figure 4: EVRI Sending Page

Evri’s main strength lies in its simplified ordering flow and clear front-page functionality. While the interface lacks refinement, the streamlined send-and-track design provides useful inspiration for reducing complexity in my own parcel management system.

DPD

URL: <https://send.dpd.co.uk>

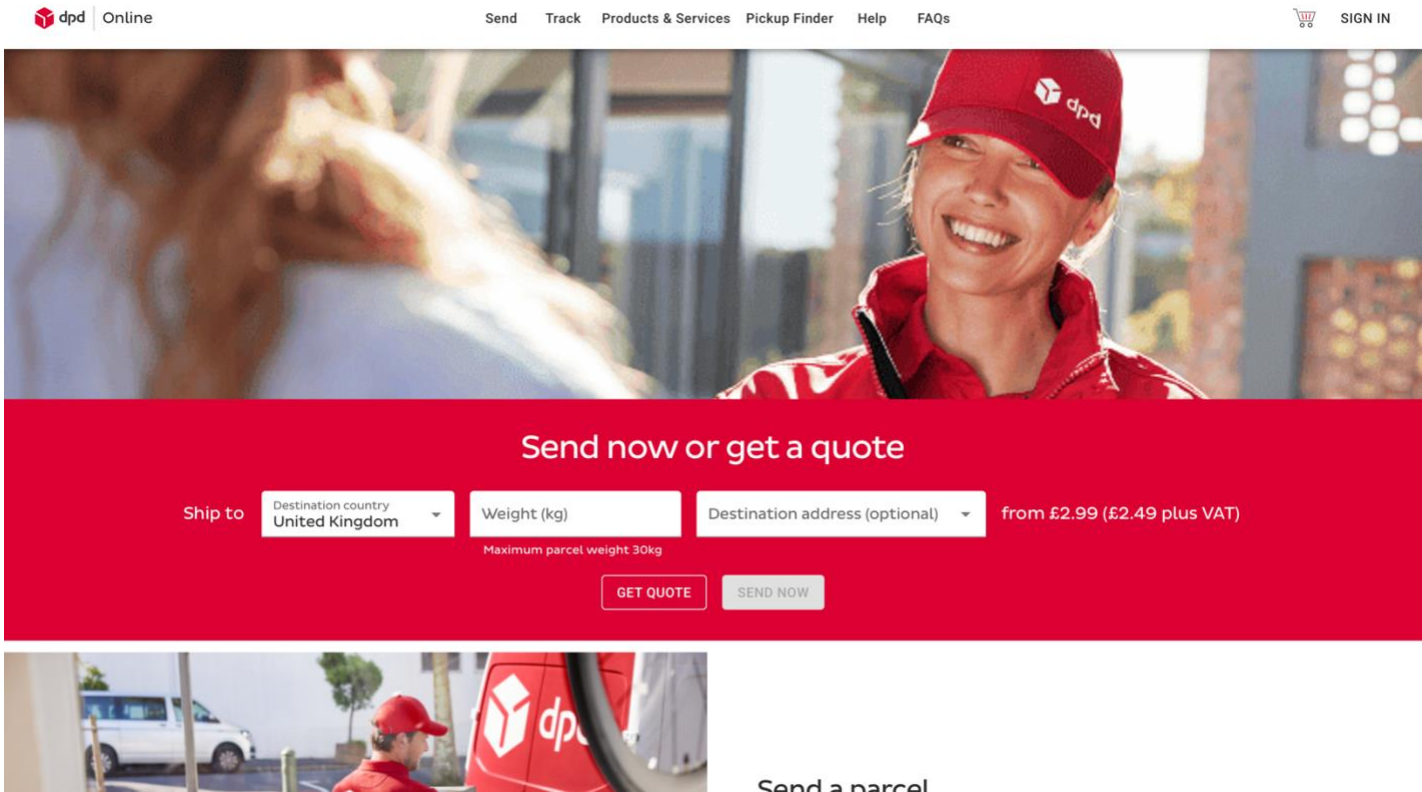
The image is a screenshot of the DPD 'Send' website. At the top, there is a navigation bar with the DPD logo and 'Online' on the left, and links for 'Send', 'Track', 'Products & Services', 'Pickup Finder', 'Help', and 'FAQs' in the center. On the right of the navigation bar are a shopping cart icon and a 'SIGN IN' link. Below the navigation bar is a large hero image of a smiling DPD delivery person in a red uniform and cap. Overlaid on the bottom half of this image is a red form titled 'Send now or get a quote'. The form contains a 'Ship to' section with a dropdown menu set to 'United Kingdom', a 'Weight (kg)' input field, and a 'Destination address (optional)' dropdown menu. To the right of these fields, it says 'from £2.99 (£2.49 plus VAT)'. Below the input fields, there is a small note 'Maximum parcel weight 30kg'. At the bottom of the form are two buttons: 'GET QUOTE' and 'SEND NOW'. Below the main hero image is a smaller image of a DPD delivery van and another delivery person, with the text 'Send a parcel' above it.

Figure 5: DPD Home Page

DPD's parcel sending system is accessed through a separate site (send.dpd.co.uk), which offers a structured step-by-step workflow for booking deliveries. Users are guided through parcel details, delivery options, and payment using a clear progress bar. Unlike Royal Mail and Evri, DPD requires manual input of parcel dimensions and declared value, which may be inconvenient for users without measuring tools. Collection and delivery options are presented clearly, though many features incur additional costs.

The screenshot displays the DPD Sending Page interface. At the top, a 'County' dropdown menu is set to 'North Yorkshire'. Below this, a section titled 'How big is your parcel?' contains input fields for Weight (kg) *, Height (cm) *, Width (cm) *, Length (cm) *, Quantity *, and Value (£) *. Each field has a maximum value indicated: Weight (30kg), Height (200cm), Width (200cm), Length (200cm), and Quantity (Maximum 99). A 'VIEW MAXIMUM PARCEL SIZES' link is provided. A '+ ADD ANOTHER PARCEL' button is at the bottom of this section. To the right, a 'Your Summary' box shows 'VAT 0.00' and 'Total (inc. VAT) 0.00'. Below the summary are logos for Google Pay, Apple Pay, PayPal, VISA, and Mastercard. A 'NEXT STEP' button is at the bottom of the summary box. At the bottom of the page, a section titled 'Where should we deliver your parcel?' offers two options: 'Direct to Pickup Point' (marked 'Most popular') and 'Deliver to the recipient'.

Figure 6: DPD Sending Page

The interface is visually clean with a consistent colour palette and strong payment support including card, PayPal, Apple Pay, and Google Pay. Payment is handled via an embedded checkout overlay, providing a smooth experience. Guest checkout is supported without mandatory account creation.

Tracking requires a parcel number and postcode, and DPD provides detailed delivery history with timestamps and locations. Based on recent personal usage, SMS notifications are sent for key events such as delivery scheduling, delivery attempts, redirections, and successful delivery, with links to a lightweight tracking page that allows delivery changes.

However, navigation between marketing pages and functional booking pages is inconsistent, and mobile usability is poor. DPD's strength lies in its detailed tracking and flexible delivery management, though the ordering process is more complex than competitors.

Investigation Summary

Overall, each courier website demonstrated different strengths and weaknesses in terms of usability, ordering flow, and tracking functionality. Royal Mail provides a professional and trustworthy interface with clear service tiers, integrated payments, and reference-based tracking, but the ordering process is fragmented across multiple pages and surrounded by large amounts of secondary content, which can distract users from the main task.

Evri offers the most direct homepage experience, with Send, Track, and Return actions immediately visible. Its progressive single-page ordering flow feels faster and less overwhelming than Royal Mail's approach. However, visual design issues such as small fonts, large unused margins, and unclear form validation reduce usability and polish.

DPD provides the most detailed tracking experience, including full delivery history with timestamps and locations, as well as SMS notifications for key events and delivery changes. Its payment system supports a wide range of methods and uses a clear step indicator during checkout. However, the requirement to manually enter parcel dimensions and the separation between marketing and booking pages increase complexity.

From this investigation, I identified several features to carry forward into my own project: a task-focused homepage similar to Evri, detailed parcel tracking and SMS updates inspired by DPD, and Royal Mail's structured service presentation and integrated payment flow. At the same time, I aim to avoid excessive page fragmentation, unnecessary form fields, and visually cluttered layouts. The goal is to combine clarity, simplicity, and meaningful tracking while keeping the user journey concise and focused.

These findings directly inform the functional and visual requirements of my proposed parcel management system.

Design Implications and Features to be Incorporated

The comparative investigation of Royal Mail, Evri, and DPD has directly informed the design decisions for this project. Rather than replicating any single system, selected strengths from each platform will be incorporated while avoiding observed usability issues.

From Royal Mail, the project will adopt a structured and professional layout with clear spacing, consistent colour usage, and strong readability. The system will also implement an accessible account registration process, allowing users to create an account in one streamlined flow rather than distributing registration steps across multiple pages. Reference-based parcel tracking without mandatory login will also be incorporated, ensuring accessibility for guest users.

From Evri, the project will adopt a task-focused homepage design, where core actions such as “Send Parcel” and “Track Parcel” are immediately visible. Additionally, a progressive form approach will be implemented, where subsequent sections of the order form only become active once previous selections are completed. This reduces cognitive overload and simplifies the user journey.

From DPD, the project will incorporate detailed tracking information including parcel status history with timestamps. SMS notifications will be implemented for key delivery events, such as dispatch and delivery confirmation, while avoiding excessive messaging. The use of a clear step indicator during the checkout process will also be adopted to improve transparency in multi-stage interactions.

At the same time, the system will intentionally avoid multi-page fragmentation, excessive promotional content, unnecessary form requirements, and complex manual parcel dimension inputs. The overall objective is to combine clarity, simplicity, and informative tracking within a streamlined and user-focused parcel management platform.